

Peaceful & Restorative Sleep

Myth Busting

- Sleep is not a luxury but a necessity for prolonged peak performance. Why else would Roger Federer be sleeping 10-hours per night and playing top level tennis at 37.
- Luckily for us as we may not have the lifestyle where 10-hours sleep is possible there are also ways to improve our sleep quality which will enable us to perform better and feel more energised.
- If you suffer from a chronic lack of sleep the research shows that we actually stop recognising the negative impact which it has on performance.

Useful Thought Experiments

- Do you need an alarm to wake you? Do you fall asleep in front of the TV? Does a low dose of alcohol make you feel drowsy? Does a warm room make you sleepy? Do you feel like nodding off in a boring meeting?
- The more you answer yes, the more sleep deprived you are.
- The last time you were on holiday can you remember how long you slept each night? This is a good indicator as to your ideal sleep length. If you can't remember then trial this on your next holiday but remember to use the second night's sleep length as your barometer as the first night is often a 'catch up' sleep.

Important New Outlook

- Improving your quantity and quality of sleep begins a lot earlier in the day than most of us recognise. Simple decisions like trying to move more, eat better and access sunlight all have a significant role to play. Other decisions like leaving the office on time by not sending those three non-essential emails can help you to create time to get to bed earlier.
- Audit your evening with the additional resource to see where your time sinks are that stop you getting to bed earlier e.g. you might notice that you spend 30-minutes perusing your Facebook newsfeed unnecessarily every evening and this can be eliminated.

Sleep Cave & Runway

- Have you taken action to ensure where you sleep is dark, cool, quiet, clean and cosy? This will help with sleep quality. Investments which you can make from cheaper to more expensive are: ear plugs, face mask, white noise machine, comfy linens and Pjs, black out blinds, sound proof windows etc.
- You can also look to get that room temperature around 18C for optimal sleep.
- Try and make the last hour before bed something you look forward to by incorporating pleasurable things like scent (candles or diffuser), reading, stretching or deep breathing.





This worksheet is going to help you get started with implementing the sleep improvement tips you've received while listening to the module.

Do not try to do too much at once. Please choose one that you feel is relatively easy to implement in each category.

For best results, make sure to track your progress of completion over the seven-day period.

Tip:

Commit to filling in progress at the end of each day as we tend to forget when we only fill it every couple of days.

**To improve my sleep,
during the day I will:**



Day 1

☐

Day 2

☐

Day 3

☐

Day 4

☐

Day 5

☐

Day 6

☐

Day 7

☐

**To improve my sleep,
when I get home I will:**



Day 1

☐

Day 2

☐

Day 3

☐

Day 4

☐

Day 5

☐

Day 6

☐

Day 7

☐

**To improve my sleep, during my sleep run way
(30-60 min. before bed) I will:**



Day 1

☐

Day 2

☐

Day 3

☐

Day 4

☐

Day 5

☐

Day 6

☐

Day 7

☐



Directions

Many of us have blindly accepted how we spend our time in the evenings so I would implore you to analyse two evenings over the next week to write down all activities you're doing from the moment you finish work (whether at the office or at home) until you get into bed.

 Time	 Activity	
		Arrive home
		Go to Sleep

 Time	 Activity	
		Arrive home
		Go to Sleep

N.B.: Be honest and go about your usual evening first without trying to be perfect. It is only once we have this true information that you will see evident time sinks deteriorating the quality of your evenings and sleep.





Writing, aka 'thinking in ink', can be a very powerful tool for self-development.

It helps people to analyse what has gone well and the factors behind it. It also helps us to see improvement opportunities when we feel we've fallen short of our standards or have learned an important lesson.

Here's a few questions which can help you start the process - try to put down your thoughts on paper for as little as 1 or 2 minutes or write for longer if you wish.

Some questions to get your writing juices flowing. Just pick one to begin with:

- 1.** How did today go? How did I feel emotionally and energetically?
- 2.** Describe one thing that happened today which put a smile on your face?
- 3.** Are there 2-3 people or events which influenced your day for the better?
- 4.** Did you encounter any difficult situations today? Any thoughts on dealing well with this issue or one of a similar nature in the future?
- 5.** Do you think that something happened today which you will never forget?

